
Policy 8

BOARD COMMITTEES

The primary purpose of all committees of the Board shall be to act in an advisory capacity to the Board.

The Board will establish standing committees and may establish subcommittees and ad hoc committees of the Board when necessary to assist the Board in fulfilling its governance functions. The Board may delegate specific powers and duties to committees of the Board subject to the restrictions on delegation outlined in the *School Act*. The powers and duties delegated to committees of the Board shall never interfere with the delegation of authority from the Board to the Superintendent of Schools.

Unless specific powers have been delegated by the Board the power of all committees shall be limited to making recommendations to the Board. Committees may act on behalf of the Board only when specifically authorized by Board motion for individual issues. The Board will carefully consider all matters referred to it by a committee. The adoption of a standing committee recommendation to the Board is not automatic.

1. BOARD COMMITTEE MEETINGS

1.1 Meeting Decorum

The Board has a strong commitment to ethical conduct. This includes the responsibility of committee participants (i.e., committee members, staff, inherent rights holder representatives, stakeholder representatives.) to conduct themselves with appropriate decorum and professionalism. It is the responsibility of the Chairperson of the Committee to see that decorum is maintained at Committee meetings so that:

- Committee participants engage in discussion by requesting to speak through the Chairperson, ensuring inclusive and orderly dialogue.
- A respectful and collegial environment is maintained as participants share diverse perspectives and contribute to meaningful discussions.
- Staff are trusted to provide objective, high-quality reports that reflect their professional expertise. Their contributions are respected and form a vital part of informed committee decision-making, free from external pressure or influence.
- Committee discussions are conducted in a constructive manner, with participants avoiding language or actions that could be perceived as personal, inflammatory, or accusatory.
- All participants are expected to demonstrate professionalism and courtesy in their interactions, contributing to a positive and productive committee culture.

1.2 Meeting Agendas

The agenda for Board committee meetings is determined through a monthly Agenda Setting meeting. This meeting is guided by the committee's work plan, matters referred to the committee by the Board, and input from the Committee Chairperson. Final decisions regarding agenda items are made by the Board Chairperson and the Board Vice Chairperson in consultation with the Superintendent of Schools and the Secretary Treasurer.

All requests for agenda items must be submitted to the Secretary Treasurer's Office no later than four (4) weeks prior to the scheduled committee meeting to ensure that they can be considered at the monthly Agenda Setting meeting. The Secretary Treasurer's Office is responsible for collecting and organizing these requests and presenting them at the Agenda Setting meeting. An agenda item is a formal request for consideration at a committee meeting and must pertain directly to matters within the committee's Board-delegated responsibilities. Agenda item requests may include questions requiring responses, requests for specific information, or proposals for discussion on relevant issues. Requests must not relate to operational matters, which should be addressed through direct engagement with staff, nor may they involve topics

designated for a private meeting under Policy 7. Each request is reviewed against the committee's terms of reference, responsibilities, and work plan. Items that meet the criteria may be added to the agenda. If a request is not included, the requestor shall be advised of the decision and the rationale for the decision.

Matters that the Board has referred to a Board committee for action must take precedence over any other Committee business.

The agenda for public committee meetings, as well as supporting materials intended to brief committee members about items included on the agenda, are electronically delivered no less than 48 hours in advance of Board committee meetings to each Trustee, Superintendent of Schools, Secretary Treasurer, inherent rights holder representatives, stakeholder representatives and resource staff for the Board committee, and published on the school district website.

1.3 Notice of Meeting

Notice of Meeting shall be provided in writing to committee members, inherent rights holder representatives and stakeholder representatives no less than five (5) calendar days prior to a scheduled Board committee meeting.

1.4 Proceedings

In all cases where the *School Act* and this Policy are silent, the current edition of Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised shall apply to procedures at meetings of Board committees.

1.5 Format and Frequency of Board Committee Meetings

Each Board committee shall be scheduled to meet at least four times per school year. Additional meetings may be added at the discretion of the Board Chairperson and the Board Vice Chairperson based on input from the Committee Chairperson and in consultation with the Superintendent of Schools and the Secretary Treasurer. Meetings may be cancelled if there are not sufficient items to warrant a meeting.

Board committee meetings may be held by electronic means to deal with matters that require immediate attention, have significant time constraints, are straight forward or procedural in nature. The format of committee meetings shall be determined by the Board Chairperson and the Board Vice Chairperson based on input from the Committee Chairperson and in consultation with the Superintendent of Schools and the Secretary Treasurer, at the Agenda Setting meeting.

1.6 Role of the Committee Chairperson and Vice Chairperson

The role of the Committee Chairperson is to provide leadership and to ensure the committee fulfills its mandate and any other matters delegated to it by the Board. In the absence of the Committee Chairperson, the Committee Vice Chairperson will exercise the powers and perform the duties and functions of the Committee Chairperson. As such, they cooperate with the Committee Chair and make every effort to learn the Committee Chairperson's role.

The Committee Chairperson will provide leadership in the planning, organization, and operation of their assigned committee's activities, including:

- Collaborate with assigned resource staff to develop proposed agenda items that support the committee's annual work plan and ensure that these are submitted to the Secretary Treasurer's Office no later than four (4) weeks prior to the scheduled committee meeting for consideration at the monthly Agenda Setting meeting.
- Mentor the Committee Vice Chairperson to be prepared to assume the role of Committee Chairperson in their absence.
- Summarize committee discussions, and state any committee action items, decisions, or timelines, before moving to the next agenda item.

- Arrange briefing meetings with the Committee Vice Chairperson and assigned resource staff as needed to review proposed agendas and support the committee's discussions and deliberations.
- Chair committee meetings, facilitating active participation by all members and ensuring appropriate time is allocated to each agenda item and all items are brought to a suitable resolution.
- Uphold and model the Board's standards of conduct and decorum during committee meetings. The Committee Chairperson is responsible for maintaining a respectful, inclusive, and orderly environment, ensuring that all participants adhere to meeting norms and that discussions remain focused and constructive.
- Report to the Board on the activities of the committee, recommendations, and resolutions.
- Develop knowledge of the subject matter and of best practices related to their assigned committee's mandate.

1.7 Minutes

Minutes of decisions made by Board committees shall be kept by the Secretary Treasurer or designate. Such minutes are to record decisions of Board committees but not the discussion or content of speeches. Movers and seconders of motions shall not be recorded in minutes.

Verbal reports made at Board committee meetings shall not be recorded in the minutes of the Board committee meetings unless the Board committee makes a decision on a matter addressed in a verbal report.

A copy of Board committee meeting minutes shall be provided to the Board. All Board committee meeting minutes shall be made available to the Board appointed auditors for review.

1.8 Public Delegations

Presentations from delegations will not be heard at Board committee meetings. Pursuant to Policy 7 – Board Operations, community members who wish to express their views on matters before the Board may request to present at a Public Board Delegation meeting.

1.9 Live-Streaming Board Committee Meetings

To ensure clarity, consistency, and respect for privacy and procedural integrity, the following rules govern the live-streaming of Board Committee meetings:

- The Board, through the Agenda Setting process, may choose to live-stream Board committee meetings.
- Live-streaming is strictly limited to the Board committee meeting proceedings.
- Individuals who attend a live-streamed meeting do so with the understanding that they may be recorded.
- The Board, through the Committee Chairperson, reserves the right to request that any unauthorized recording of committee proceedings be stopped immediately. The minutes of the meeting will record that such direction was given.
- Where a concern arises involving inappropriate recording or sharing of personally recorded audiovisual material, the Board will review the use and may take action to request that the recording be deleted/destroyed.
- Recordings of past Board committee meetings may be archived online for up to one year.

2. STANDING COMMITTEES

2.1 Purpose of Standing Committees

The primary purpose of standing committees is to act in an advisory capacity to the Board and to support good governance and informed decision making by the Board. When an agenda matter falls within the responsibilities of more than one standing committee a joint committee meeting may be organized by the Board Chairperson and the Board Vice Chairperson based on input from the Committee Chairpersons and in consultation with the Superintendent of Schools and the Secretary Treasurer, at the Agenda Setting meeting.

All standing committee recommendations approved by majority vote of the committee members shall be included on the agenda at a Regular Meeting of the Board in the form of a proposed motion. The recommendations of a standing committee shall not be binding unless formally approved by the Board.

Standing committee work plans shall be created annually based on the Board's work plan and in alignment with the Education Plan.

2.2 Membership and Quorum

Standing committee membership includes one trustee appointed as Chairperson, one trustee appointed as Vice Chairperson, two trustees appointed as members and two trustees appointed as alternate members. The appointments are made by the Board on the recommendation of the Board Chairperson.

The Board Chairperson serves as an ex-officio member of all standing committees. This does not increase the total number of committee members.

A quorum shall consist of a majority of standing committee members, meaning at least three members must be present. If any regular standing committee members are absent, up to two alternate members may serve in their place and be counted toward quorum. The Board Chairperson may be counted for the purpose of establishing quorum if fewer than four appointed members (including alternates) are present.

If a quorum is not present within fifteen (15) minutes of the scheduled start time, the committee meeting cannot proceed with official business or decision-making and the meeting shall be adjourned. Urgent matters will be promptly forwarded to the Board for consideration, while non-urgent agenda items will be deferred to an upcoming committee meeting.

The Chairperson of a standing committee may move any recommendation and speak to any question during committee meetings without leaving the chair and may vote on all matters considered.

Any member of the Board may attend standing committee meetings and participate in discussions, but only appointed members of the standing committee may vote. The Board Chairperson may only vote if fewer than four appointed members (including alternates) are present.

2.3 Standing Committee Inherent Rights Holder and Stakeholder Representatives

The Board shall invite one inherent rights holder representative of each of the Host Nations: xʷməθkʷəy̓əm (Musqueam), Skwxwú7mesh Úxwumixw (Squamish Nation) & səliłwətał (Tsleil-Waututh Nation) to attend standing committee meetings.

The Board shall invite one student representative designated by the Vancouver District Students' Council (VDSC) and one parent representative designated by the District Parent Advisory Council (DPAC).

The Board shall invite one representative of each of the following groups to attend standing committee meetings:

- Canadian Union of Public Employees, Local 15 (CUPE 15)
- Canadian Union of Public Employees, Local 407 (CUPE 407)
- International Union of Operating Engineers, Local 963 (IUOE)
- Bargaining Council of Vancouver School Board Construction and Maintenance Trades Unions (BCVSBMTU)
- Professional and Administrative Staff Association (PASA)
- Vancouver Association of Secondary School Administrators (VASSA)
- Vancouver Elementary and Adult Educators' Society (VEAES)
- Vancouver Elementary Principals' and Vice Principals' Association (VEPVPA)
- Vancouver Secondary Teachers' Association (VSTA)

Representatives attending committee meetings are entrusted with the responsibility of presenting the perspectives and interests of the organizations that they represent. It is essential that they articulate these collective views rather than their personal opinions.

2.4 Standing Committee Resource Staff and Subject Matter Experts

The Superintendent of Schools shall appoint resource staff to work with standing committees and the Superintendent of Schools shall determine the roles, responsibilities, and reporting requirements of the resource staff. At the discretion of the Superintendent of Schools, subject matter experts may be invited to present alongside staff at committee meetings.

The Superintendent of Schools or the appointed resource staff shall keep the Chairperson of each of the standing committees informed of matters within the jurisdiction of the standing committee.

2.5 Standing Committees Responsibilities

The Board has established four standing committees:

- A. Policy and Governance Committee
- B. Facilities Planning Committee
- C. Education Plan Committee
- D. Finance and Personnel Committee

A. Policy and Governance Committee Responsibilities:

- A.1 Review the policy framework for the organization and make policy recommendations to the Board.
- A.2 Assess and make recommendations regarding Board governance structures.
- A.3 Ensure Board Policies are reviewed at least once in a four-year term and that compliance with legislation, regulations and legislative mandate is maintained.
- A.4 Review and make recommendations to the Board on the school district's compliance with legislative requirements.
- A.5 Annually review and recommend an Advocacy Plan to the Board that supports the achievement of the Board's strategic objectives.
- A.6 Review matters referred to the committee by the Board and make recommendations as requested.

B. Facilities Planning Committee Responsibilities:

- B.1 Review and provide recommendations to the Board regarding assigned facilities planning matters.
- B.2 Annually review and make recommendations to the Board regarding the five-year capital plan and the spending plan for the annual facilities grant.
- B.3 Review and make recommendations to the Board regarding the long-range facilities plan.

- B.4 Review and make recommendations to the Board regarding catchment areas for schools and District programs.
- B.5 For the purpose of naming and renaming schools, provide recommendations to the Board, adhering to the guidelines and direction set by the Board at the beginning of any potential school naming or renaming process.
- B.6 Review matters referred to the Committee by the Board and make recommendations as requested.

C. Education Plan Committee Responsibilities:

- C.1 Review and make recommendations to the Board regarding matters related to the development and implementation of the Education Plan.
- C.2 Review and make recommendations to the Board regarding the annual Framework for Enhancing Student Learning Report.
- C.3 Review and make recommendations to the Board regarding proposed Board Authority Authorized Courses.
- C.4 Review and make recommendations regarding the implementation and cessation of District programs.
- C.5 Review and make recommendations to the Board regarding annual school learning plans.
- C.6 Review and make recommendations to the Board regarding school calendars.
- C.7 Review matters referred to the Committee by the Board and make recommendations as requested.

D. Finance and Personnel Committee Responsibilities:

- D.1 Review and provide recommendations to the Board regarding assigned finance and personnel matters.
- D.2 Review quarterly financial reports and assist the Board in being fiscally responsible by managing its financial resources effectively and efficiently.
- D.3 Review and provide recommendations to the Board regarding the annual financial plan, the annual budget, the amended annual financial plan and the amended budget.
- D.4 Review and provide recommendations to the Board regarding the approval of school fees and fees related to programs that charge fees.
- D.5 Review and monitor the school district's human resources management strategy to ensure that human resources plans and initiatives will enable the school district to achieve its strategic objectives.
- D.6 Review matters referred to the Committee by the Board and make recommendations as requested.

2.6. Subcommittees to Board Standing Committees

Subcommittees may be formed to support a Board standing committee in addressing complex or specialized areas that would benefit from focused attention. These subcommittees enable a smaller group of trustees and staff to explore issues in greater depth, develop informed recommendations, and engage relevant inherent rights holders, stakeholders and interest holders.

The terms of reference for each subcommittee will be approved by the Board at the time of the formation and attached as an appendix to this policy for reference. The Chairperson of the Board standing committee serves as a member of the subcommittee, ensuring alignment and continuity.

The Superintendent of Schools shall appoint resource staff to work with subcommittees and the Superintendent of Schools shall determine the roles, responsibilities, and reporting requirements of the resource staff and subject matter experts.

3. STANDALONE AUDIT COMMITTEE

3.1 Membership and Quorum

Audit committee membership includes one trustee appointed as Chairperson, one trustee appointed as Vice Chairperson, two trustees appointed as members and two trustees appointed as alternate members. The appointments are made by the Board on the recommendation of the Board Chairperson.

The Board Chairperson serves as an ex-officio member of the Audit committee. This does not increase the total number of committee members.

A quorum shall consist of a majority of Audit committee members, meaning at least three members must be present. If any regular Audit committee members are absent, up to two alternate members may serve in their place and be counted toward quorum. The Board Chairperson may be counted for the purpose of establishing quorum if fewer than four appointed members (including alternates) are present.

If a quorum is not present within fifteen (15) minutes of the scheduled start time, the committee meeting cannot proceed with official business or decision-making and the meeting shall be adjourned. Urgent matters will be promptly forwarded to the Board for consideration, while non-urgent agenda items will be deferred to an upcoming committee meeting.

The Chairperson of the Audit committee may move any recommendation and speak to any question during committee meetings without leaving the chair and may vote on all matters considered.

Any member of the Board may attend the Audit committee meetings and participate in discussions, but only appointed members of the Audit committee may vote. The Board Chairperson may only vote if fewer than four appointed members (including alternates) are present.

3.2 Audit Committee Resource Staff

The Superintendent of Schools shall appoint resource staff to work with the audit committee. Resource staff shall normally include the Secretary Treasurer.

3.3 Independent Audit Committee Members

Up to two members of the public with one such public member holding an accounting designation may be appointed by the Board as a resource to the audit committee. Public members will be appointed by the Board for a term of two years with the possibility of a second two-year term extension, at the will of the Board.

3.4 Audit Committee Responsibilities

- 1) Financial Oversight
 - a) Review the annual audited financial statements and recommend approval of the audited statements by the Board.
 - b) Review quarterly financial statements and, if required, recommend approval of the quarterly financial statements by the Board.
 - c) Monitor the development of and changes to accounting principles and practices and financial reporting standards, and their impact on the School District's financial reporting.
 - d) Review the draft annual financial plan and the annual budget.
- 2) Audit and Risk Oversight
 - a) Review audit results with external auditors and monitor implementation of recommendations.
 - b) Oversee the engagement of external auditors, including audit terms and proposed fees.

- c) Review the scope of non-audit services to ensure auditor independence.
 - d) Review external audit services at least every three years.
 - e) Recommend terms of engagement for the external auditor to the Board.
 - f) Review the auditor's assessment of management's risk mitigation strategies and internal controls, with emphasis on safeguarding District assets.
 - g) Meet privately with external auditors, without staff present, when necessary.
 - h) Make inquiries of the auditor as needed to fulfill the Committee's fiduciary responsibilities.
- 3) As appropriate, make policy recommendations to the Board related to the role of the audit committee

4. AD HOC COMMITTEES

Ad hoc committees may be established to assist the Board on a specific project for a specific period of time. The terms of reference for each ad hoc committee will be established by Board motion at the time of the formation. Such ad hoc committees shall cease to exist when the purpose has been achieved. The Chairperson of the Board shall appoint membership and the Chairperson of the ad hoc committee. The Board may invite inherent rights holder representatives and stakeholder representatives to attend ad hoc committee meetings.

The Superintendent of Schools shall appoint resource staff to work with ad hoc committees and the Superintendent of Schools shall determine the roles, responsibilities, and reporting requirements of the resource staff and subject matter experts.

Legal Reference: Section 65, 85 *School Act*

Adopted: October 29, 2025

APPENDIX A

ADVOCACY SUBCOMMITTEE TERMS OF REFERENCE

The primary purpose of the Advocacy Subcommittee shall be to act in an advisory capacity to the Policy and Governance Committee and the Board.

Advocacy subcommittee work plans shall be created annually based on the Board's annual plan for advocacy and meetings will be scheduled as needed through the agenda setting process.

Advocacy Subcommittee Responsibilities:

- Annually review advocacy needs and recommend changes to the Board's Advocacy Plan to the Policy and Governance Committee. All recommended changes must be in alignment with Board Policy, applicable legislation and support the achievement of the Board's strategic objectives.
- Identify and recommend to the Policy and Governance Committee effective advocacy tactics that can be employed to advance the accomplishment of the goals identified in the Board's Advocacy Plan.
- Monitor and report on progress in the implementation of the Board's Advocacy Plan and provide regular updates to the Board via the Policy and Governance Committee.
- Review matters referred to the subcommittee by the Board and make recommendations as requested.

Membership and Quorum

Advocacy subcommittee membership includes one trustee appointed as Chairperson, one trustee appointed as Vice Chairperson, one trustee appointed as member and two trustees appointed as alternate members. The Chairperson of the Policy and Governance Committee shall be a member of the Advocacy subcommittee. The appointments are made by the Board on the recommendation of the Board Chairperson.

A quorum shall be a majority of subcommittee members, two of which may be the alternate subcommittee members.

Any member of the Board may attend the advocacy subcommittee meetings and participate in discussions, but only appointed members of the subcommittee may vote.

Inherent Rights Holder and Stakeholder Representatives

The Board shall invite inherent rights holder representatives and stakeholder representatives as identified in Policy 8 - Board Committees.

Representatives attending subcommittee meetings are entrusted with the responsibility of presenting the perspectives and interests of the organizations that they represent. It is essential that they articulate these collective views rather than their personal opinions.

Advocacy Subcommittee Resource Staff

The Superintendent of Schools shall appoint resource staff to work with the advocacy subcommittee.